

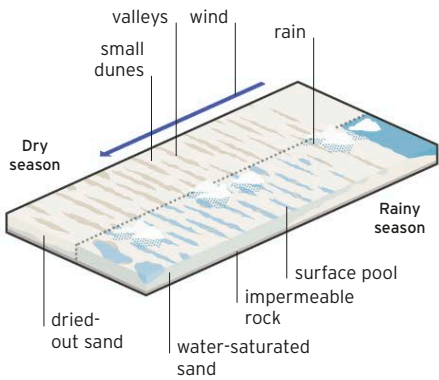


◁ CLEAR WATERS

The pools are typically crescent-shaped with crystal-clear water. They can be up to 10 ft (3 m) deep.

SEASONAL CHANGES

In the dry season (September to November), strong winds blowing over Lençóis Maranhenses dry its surface and form sand dunes, with small valleys in between. In the rainy season, the valleys fill with water, which is prevented from percolating downward by a layer of impermeable rock lying under the sand.



Cape Horn

A headland at the southern tip of South America, notorious for the atrocious weather conditions that often develop nearby



◁ BREEDING AT THE CAPE

Some breeding colonies of Magellanic Penguin are found on coasts around the cape.

Cape Horn is a rocky headland at the southern end of a small island called Hornos, in the Chilean part of Tierra del Fuego. It was named after the city of Hoorn in the Netherlands, the birthplace of the Dutch navigator Willem Corneliszoon Schouten, who rounded it in 1616.

Its importance and mystique derives from the fact that it is a navigational landmark, marking the northern edge of the Drake Passage, the strait between the southern tip of South America and the northern tip of the Antarctic Peninsula. "Rounding the Horn" is one of the main ways of moving between the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, and because the sea around the headland is noted for its bad weather—including powerful winds, large waves, and a risk of icebergs—sailors rightly consider it a major challenge. The number of ships rounding Cape Horn from the Atlantic Ocean to the Pacific Ocean dropped sharply when the Panama Canal opened in 1914.



◁ HIGH POINT

The rocky, roughly pyramid-shaped landmass known as Cape Horn stands 1,390 ft (425 m) tall at its most elevated point.